PUBLIC DIAGNOSTIC EXEMPLAR · 02 IN READING ORDER

OUTLIER

/ AI · PLATFORM RELIABILITY

STRUCTURAL DIAGNOSIS

Recurring Platform Failure — from publicly observable evidence.

> *"Outlier is recruiting experts to do compliance work.*
> *That is why the fixes haven't held."*

ARTIFACT FAMILY

#	ARTIFACT	ACCESS
01	Translation Artifact	Public
02	**Diagnostic Artifact**	← *This document*
03	Redesign Executive Summary	Public
04	Full Redesign Artifact	Restricted

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EVIDENTIARY STANDARD	JUDGMENT BOUNDARY
This artifact distinguishes directly evidenced facts [A][B], convergent public symptom patterns [C], consequence evidence [D], and structural inference [E]. The governing diagnosis is a high-confidence structural inference from convergent public evidence — not a claim about internal intent. Full source documentation is in Section 14. **Evidence-class discipline:** [C] sources are convergent symptom evidence — not proof of any individual event. [D] sources are consequence evidence and, where legal proceedings remain unresolved, allegation-level evidence only. [E] marks structural inference derived from convergence across public evidence classes. No single complaint, lawsuit, review, or forum post is treated as sufficient proof.	This artifact makes no claim about intentional deception, fraud, or bad faith by Outlier or Scale AI. The mismatch described is consistent with rapid scaling under conflicting commercial pressures, not with malice or misconduct. No inference is made about internal dashboard logic, undisclosed client instructions, or adjudicated legal liability. **What this artifact does not say:** It does not claim Outlier or Scale AI acted in bad faith. It does not claim adjudicated liability. It does not claim access to internal communications or proprietary systems. It does not claim all contributors are misclassified. It does not prescribe a technology solution.

SECTION 0

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

This is a structural diagnosis from public evidence. It is not a legal brief, an operational audit, a moral judgment, a technology assessment, or a redesign specification. It identifies the governing primitive, the first structural break, the function collapse condition, the compensatory burden layer, and the dependency order for correction — derived entirely from publicly observable system behaviour.

The Full Redesign Artifact (Artifact 04 in this family) specifies the target-state architecture, transition sequence, and implementation logic. This document defines what must be corrected and in what order. It does not specify how. For role-level implementation, see Artifact 04, Section 16.

RECOMMENDED READING ORDER	
Start here	Translation Artifact (Artifact 01) — plain-language explanation for all audiences
Full evidence	Diagnostic Artifact (Artifact 02) — this document
Replacement logic	Redesign Executive Summary (Artifact 03) — public board summary
Builder spec	Full Redesign Artifact (Artifact 04) — restricted; not published publicly

SECTION 0.1

PLAIN-LANGUAGE GLOSSARY

Technical terms used in this artifact, defined for non-specialist readers.

TERM	PLAIN MEANING
Ghost structure	Hidden human work — Queue Managers interpreting queue logic, contributors maintaining their own tracking tools, community members building open-source patches — that the platform architecture should carry but does not.

TERM	PLAIN MEANING
Collapse node	The single point where too many system failures converge. Here: the one-frame contributor architecture that compresses two incompatible work types into the same gate, scoring layer, and interface.
Sensing-authority fusion	When the system's quality detection (sensing) is directly coupled to irreversible consequence (deactivation, pay reduction) with no human review layer in between. A mis-specified sensor with executive authority produces systematic error at scale.
Generative reframing	The capability to detect that a rubric, task definition, or boundary condition is itself wrong — and surface that signal to a layer that can act on it. No public contributor-facing route with upstream authority was identified in the evidence reviewed.
Retained-capability loss	The economic framing of recruitment cost: intake cost is spent acquiring specialist capability, but the operating frame may fail to retain, reuse, or route that capability across project cycles.
Signal switch	The moment a contributor who entered through expertise-coded recruitment receives their first reliability-coded rubric. The question shifts from 'use your expertise' to 'match the manual'.

SECTION 0.2

DIAGNOSTIC SPINE

The complete diagnostic finding in governed form. Every section of this artifact traces back to one or more rows of this table.

DIAGNOSTIC ELEMENT	FINDING
Governing primitive	Expertise-coded reliability pipeline
Stated promise (paraphrased)	Expert human judgment improves advanced AI systems
Actual operating object	Variance-controlled instruction adherence at scale
First structural break	Qualification-to-execution handoff — where expertise-coded selection meets reliability-coded execution for the first time
Function collapse	Sensing fused with authority: automated scoring detects quality and can trigger consequence (deactivation, pay reduction) without a sufficiently legible, contributor-accessible review layer between detection and action
Missing function	Portable cross-project contributor continuity — public evidence is consistent with repeated project-level requalification rather than durable contributor memory
Hidden burden carriers	Queue Managers (ambiguity absorption); contributors (queue-state inference, unpaid onboarding); community tooling (EmptyQueue-Extension, GitHub)
Correction prerequisite	Name the primitive correctly at leadership level before redesigning any gate, stream, or interface
Proof condition	**Same pressure → different response.** The redesign is real only when the failure pattern does not return under identical structural conditions.

SECTION 1

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Outlier has a recurring platform failure that its current correction loops have not resolved. Public evidence includes credentialed contributors who fail or leave production, qualified contributors encountering Empty Queue states, and specialists reporting work materially different from the expertise-coded recruitment surface. Documented interventions — including stricter credentials, longer guidelines, Marketplace visibility, dashboard changes, Queue Manager support and webinars — operate inside the existing contributor frame rather than replacing it.

> **GOVERNING DIAGNOSIS**
>
> ***Outlier recruits through the grammar of an expertise market while operating through the mechanics of a reliability pipeline.***

Directional cost anchor [C][D][E]: With more than 100,000 experts reported by Outlier on its public company surface [A], the mismatch can compound recruitment reacquisition, QM support overhead, dispute exposure and upstream signal risk. Public evidence does not establish a cohort-level churn rate for high-signal specialists. See Section 11 for the cost-class breakdown.

An expertise market purchases open-ended specialist judgment and values correct variance. A reliability pipeline purchases repeatable instruction adherence under constraint and suppresses variance through qualification gates, unitised tasks, rubrics, and continuous quality control. Outlier's recruitment surface signals the first. Its execution layer runs the second.

The first structural break occurs at the qualification-to-execution handoff. Contributors are selected through expertise-coded signals — degrees, LinkedIn profiles, domain screenings, identity verification — then moved into success conditions dominated by rubric adherence, timing, formatting, and bounded outputs. The work shifts from *use your expertise* to *match the manual*. The expertise is not consumed. Compliance is consumed. More precisely: **the scoring layer treats specialist variance as a failure signal. A contributor whose domain knowledge leads them to diverge from the rubric can be algorithmically downgraded. The system does not need to intend this outcome for the structure to produce it: where specialist judgment conflicts with rubric conformity, the visible scoring architecture appears to reward conformity over correct domain variance.**

This is why the documented correction classes have not resolved the governing mismatch. Stricter credentials tighten a gate measuring the wrong input class. Longer guidelines can intensify the signal-switch. Each intervention addresses its own layer; none replaces the primitive.

A second-order consequence is compensatory human labour. Queue Managers — contributors, not employees — function as human bridges between opaque routing, shifting guidelines, and contributor confusion. Their role is load-bearing, not supplementary. A third-order consequence: community members built the EmptyQueue-Extension specifically to surface the 19 EQ reason codes not surfaced in the contributor-facing interface. When the system's opacity is corrected by open-source tooling, the structural failure has exceeded its own carrier layer.

BOARD VERDICT

Outlier is an expertise-coded reliability pipeline. Its recurring failure is not best explained as a contributor problem. It is a category error embedded in the system's primitive. Correct the primitive, or downstream fixes remain exposed to the same mismatch.

SECTION 2

ENGAGEMENT SCOPE

System under analysis

The Outlier contributor platform — the full contributor lifecycle from recruitment surface through qualification, onboarding, task routing, quality-scoring, queue-state, support layers, payment, and the external consequence layer where legal and reputational pressure have appeared.

Framing note

The structural mismatch diagnosed here is not a moral failure. It is the predictable output of a system scaled rapidly under commercial pressure — Scale AI's obligation to deliver reliable, high-throughput training data to frontier AI clients — while its public recruitment surface used the grammar of expert sourcing. The two requirements point in opposite directions. The mismatch is structural, not intentional.

Parent system context

Outlier sits inside Scale AI's commercial mandate to deliver reliable, scalable human-generated inputs for AI customers [A]. Scale has publicly served major AI-model developers and enterprise and government customers. Those relationships have changed over time: following Meta's June 2025 investment, Reuters reported that several major AI-lab customers were reducing or reassessing Scale relationships [D]. The reliability-and-scale constraint remains the relevant structural condition.

Evidence basis

This diagnosis is based entirely on publicly available materials, reviewed through September 2026. Primary sources [A]: Outlier official surfaces; Scale AI official materials; Oxford Economics commissioned report (December 2025). Symptom evidence [C]: Glassdoor, Indeed, Trustpilot, Quora, Reddit (r/outlier_ai), BBB complaints, GitHub (EmptyQueue-Extension). Consequence evidence [D]: McKinney v. Scale AI (December 2024), Rogowicz PAGA (January 2025), psychological-harm litigation (January 2025), Bloomberg WARN Act reporting (October 2024), TechCrunch reporting on the DOL investigation opened in 2025 and later reported closed in May 2025, The Guardian (April 2026), Reuters and TechCrunch reporting on Scale AI customer relationships (June 2025), and Fairwork Cloudwork Ratings for Scale / Remotasks (2023) and Remotasks (2025).

Fixed constraints

Contractor classification model; client NDA and codename structure; demand-driven project availability; algorithmic quality scoring backbone; core task types (rating/ranking, prompt creation, editing, annotation). Internal systems, proprietary routing logic, client contracts, and internal quality dashboards are excluded. All legal references are allegation-level evidence, not adjudicated findings.

SECTION 3

FAILURE PATTERN RECONSTRUCTED FROM PUBLIC EVIDENCE

The following represents the operating problem as the public record reconstructs it — in the platform's functional language, before structural translation. These statements are derived from convergent public sources [A][C], not from undisclosed internal communications.

CLAIM TYPE	HOW THIS ARTIFACT TREATS IT
First-party platform statements [A][B]	Direct evidence of stated promise or operating surface. Treated as the most reliable source class.
Contributor reports [C]	Convergent symptom evidence. No individual report is treated as proof. Pattern across many sources is treated as structural signal.
Legal filings [D]	Allegation-level consequence evidence. Legal proceedings are unresolved. Claims are treated as consistent with the structural diagnosis, not as adjudicated proof of it.
Media and investigation reports [D]	Public consequence evidence. Treated as corroborating the consequence layer, not as primary structural proof.
Structural diagnosis [E]	Inference from convergence across all source classes. Clearly marked [E]. Not a claim about internal intent or undisclosed systems.

- → Intake success does not reliably predict success inside the production workflow in the public evidence reviewed.
- → Reports include credentialed and high-signal contributors who fail assessment gates, encounter work materially different from what they expected, or disengage.
- → Contributor evidence includes disagreement between rubric-conformant scoring and perceived domain-quality output.
- → Quality variance is reported despite increasingly strict compliance layers.
- → Empty Queue states recur. Demand scarcity and project availability can explain an empty queue; the diagnostic concern here is opacity about contributor-relevant queue state.
- → Queue Managers, webinars, office hours and war rooms appear as recurring compensatory support infrastructure.

These are not treated as isolated complaints or as population statistics. Their recurrence across qualification, production, routing and retention is the structural signal examined in this diagnostic.

SECTION 4

EARLY STRUCTURAL SIGNALS

Five structural signals are visible from the public record before the formal diagnosis is applied.

1. The two grammars diverge at the handoff.

The recruitment surface is uniformly expertise-coded: degrees, LinkedIn profiles, academic verification, specialist domain selection [A]. The execution surface is uniformly reliability-coded: standardised tasks, time limits, 50+ page rubrics, algorithmic scoring by formatting compliance and time-on-task [A][B]. Two different grammars describing two different systems, operating on the same contributor population with no reconciliation mechanism between them.

2. The documented corrections are predominantly interface-level.

The public correction responses examined here address surfaces such as routing, navigation, compliance and intake filtering [A]. They do not publicly establish a replacement of the governing production primitive. The structural question is therefore whether correction has remained inside the existing frame.

3. Compensatory human structures have become load-bearing.

Queue Managers exist to absorb system ambiguity that the platform's own information architecture cannot carry [C]. When an organisation requires a permanent human layer to interpret its own operational conditions to the people doing its core work, the failure sits at a level below the interface.

4. The external pressure is patterned, not random.

Litigation, investigative journalism and historical labour-standards evidence cluster around contributor conditions and consequence pathways [D]. A federal DOL investigation reported in March 2025 was reported closed in May 2025 without a public finding of wrongdoing. These sources are consequence evidence, not proof of the governing diagnosis or of liability.

5. The system's opacity has been externalised into third-party tooling.

The EmptyQueue-Extension (GitHub: andreytakhtamirov) was built specifically to surface the 19 EQ reason codes visible in the platform's developer tools but not surfaced in the contributor-facing interface [C]. When contributors must build open-source tooling to access information that exists in the platform's own developer environment, the system's coordination costs have been externalised beyond its own human carrier layer. This is strong evidence that queue-state opacity is an information-architecture condition rather than a pure technical limitation: the data exists in the platform environment; the contributor-facing interface does not surface it.

Not every empty queue is structural: contributors reported projects paused after Meta's June 2025 investment in Scale AI [D]. That explains why some queues emptied. It does not explain why contributors could not see the reason. This diagnosis concerns the second.

SECTION 4.1

COMMON MISDIAGNOSES

The following explanations are frequently proposed for Outlier's recurring failure. Each is downstream of the actual break and does not reach it.

MISDIAGNOSIS	WHY IT IS INSUFFICIENT
Contributor quality problem	The gate selects for expertise signals while the production system rewards compliance. High-quality contributors can fail a test designed for the wrong work class.
Guideline clarity problem	Where the primitive remains mismatched, additional specification can intensify the signal-switch by increasing compliance load without resolving the underlying work-class mismatch.
Routing inefficiency	Routing is downstream of the qualification gate. Routing cannot compensate for a gate that admits contributors into the wrong work class.
Support problem	QM support load is generated by structural ambiguity. Adding more support absorbs symptoms; it does not remove the source.
Dashboard / interface problem	Interface visibility cannot correct a wrong primitive. Making the Empty Queue more visible does not correct the mismatch that produces it.

MISDIAGNOSIS	WHY IT IS INSUFFICIENT
Scaling problem	Scale exposes the mismatch; it does not create it. More contributors through a broken gate produce more failure, not different failure.
Legal / compliance problem	Legal pressure is consequence evidence, not the cause. Changing arbitration clauses or disclosure terms does not stop the system from scoring expertise as error. It changes the venue of the failure, not the source.

LONGER GUIDELINES DO NOT RESOLVE A PRIMITIVE MISMATCH — [C]

Contributor evidence reviewed for this diagnostic includes guideline sets reported at roughly 20 pages and more than 50 pages. The evidence supports the existence of increasing specification and contributor reports of substantial instruction-learning burden; it does not by itself establish management motive or a single causal response sequence. Structurally, additional specification can intensify the signal-switch when the underlying problem is a mismatch between expertise-coded intake and reliability-coded execution.

SECTION 5

SYSTEM BOUNDARY MAP

Figure 1 — Category Divergence Map

Two incompatible grammars operating simultaneously on the same contributor population, with the qualification gate as the point where the mismatch becomes operational.

FEATURE	RECRUITMENT GRAMMAR (expertise-coded)	EXECUTION GRAMMAR (reliability-coded)
What is signalled	Specialist judgment, credentialed access, expert contribution	Rubric adherence, task completion, compliance
Success metric	Depth of domain expertise	Formatting, time-on-task, peer reviewer agreement
Feedback loop	Specialist validation	Algorithmic scoring, EQ state
Unit of work	Open-ended problem, judgment call	Bounded task with defined output format
Variance	Valued — correct variance is the product	Suppressed — variance is the failure signal
Memory	Implied portfolio, cumulative expertise	Project-local; no portable record identified in public evidence

Queue Managers appear as a compensatory loop outside the main pipeline, absorbing ambiguity generated by the grammar mismatch. No public contributor-facing Upstream Signal Channel with demonstrated authority was identified in the evidence reviewed.

Primary actors

ACTOR	ROLE	POSITION IN SYSTEM
Prospective contributor	Self-selects based on recruitment grammar	Pre-intake
Contributor (Attempter)	Completes entry-level tasks under rubric	Production layer

ACTOR	ROLE	POSITION IN SYSTEM
Contributor (Reviewer)	Quality-assesses other contributors' work	QA layer
Contributor (Oracle)	Senior review and escalation	QA escalation
Queue Manager (QM)	Interprets system ambiguity; hosts webinars and war rooms	Coherence layer (undesigned)
Algorithmic scoring system	Detects quality; triggers access, payment, removal	Authority layer
Project routing system	Matches contributors to available tasks	Routing layer
Client (codename-protected)	Sets task definitions, rubrics, project scope	Upstream
Scale AI	Sets commercial mandate, owns client relationships	Parent

FIVE POINTS WHERE STRUCTURAL FAILURE CONCENTRATES

1. What constitutes a passing assessment — currently measures the wrong input class [A][B][C]
2. How quality scores are calculated — currently measures compliance, not expertise [B][C]
3. Why a contributor's queue is empty — currently not surfaced to contributors [B][C]
4. Whether a contributor can appeal a score or deactivation — no sufficiently legible contributor-facing review mechanism was identified in the public evidence [B][D]
5. Whether upstream reframing feedback is collected — no public contributor-facing route with demonstrated upstream authority was identified [A][B]

SECTION 6

WORKFLOW AND PIPELINE TRACE

The documented operating sequence:

Diagram key: <-- signal feeds into this layer · x no public contributor-facing mechanism identified in the evidence reviewed

```
EXPERTISE-CODED RECRUITMENT
        |
        v
QUALIFICATION GATE  <---  [expertise signals: degrees, domain, LinkedIn]
        |
        |  <--  SIGNAL SWITCH (First Structural Break)
        v
RELIABILITY-CODED EXECUTION
        |
        v
ALGORITHMIC SCORING  <---  [measures: rubric adherence, time-on-task]
        |
        |   [no sufficiently legible review layer identified
        |    between signal and consequence]
        v
ROUTING / PAY / REMOVAL CONSEQUENCE
        |
        v
CONTRIBUTOR CHURN + QM BURDEN + PUBLIC PRESSURE

Structural absences:
  x  Portable cross-project contributor memory
  x  Upstream expert signal channel
  x  Separated review authority (sensing fused with consequence)
  x  Contributor-visible queue state (19 EQ codes not surfaced in contributor interface)
```

Detailed trace

1. Contributor creates account, uploads resume, selects skills, completes ID verification via Persona [B]
2. System cross-references LinkedIn, validates academic email, verifies publications [B]
3. Contributor is offered project-specific onboarding — or hits Empty Queue immediately [A][C]
4. Contributor reads guidelines (50+ pages), may attend webinars — inconsistently compensated [B][C][D]
5. Contributor completes qualification task graded by AI or peer reviewers [A][B]
6. If pass: contributor enters production queue. If fail: no explanation provided [C]
7. Contributor receives unitised task with time limit, rubric, and output format [A][B]
8. Response scored algorithmically or by peer reviewers [A][B]
9. Score affects future task access, project eligibility, tier status [B][C]
10. When demand drops or project ends: blank dashboard, no explanation, no timeline [C]
11. Contributor seeks help from Queue Managers — webinars, Slack, war rooms [C]
12. Contributor either continues through cycles or churns [C][D]

Critical structural observations

→ No public contributor-facing upstream-reframing route with demonstrated authority was identified [A][B]. The public workflow evidence reviewed is oriented to producing and evaluating output rather than routing rubric or task-definition defects upstream.

→ Public contributor evidence is consistent with project-local memory and repeated requalification. Durable cross-project performance continuity is not visible in the evidence reviewed [A][B][C].

→ The Empty Queue is not a workflow step. It is a silent capacity management mechanism [B][C]. 19 EQ reason codes are visible in the platform's developer tools (browser network tab) but are not surfaced in

the contributor-facing interface. This is an information-architecture condition: the codes exist in the platform environment; contributors cannot access them without external tooling.

→ Queue Managers are inserted after the fact — a structural patch, not a designed component [C].

SECTION 7

FUNCTIONAL DIAGNOSIS

Applying the Four-Function Law [E]: institutions fail under scale when sensing, interpretation, authority, and memory remain fused or misaligned at the point of consequence.

FUNCTION	FORMAL LOCATION	CONDITION	STRUCTURAL CONSEQUENCE
Sensing	Algorithmic scoring + peer review	Mis-specified — calibrated to detect rubric adherence proxies rather than the recruited input class	Quality detection operates on the wrong signal. Specialist variance can be flagged as failure. [A][B][C]
Interpretation	QM layer + guideline documents	Fragmented — displaced into informal, non-authoritative human support	Meaning of quality varies by project and reviewer. Consistent contributors receive inconsistent scores — no stable signal for routing or contributor trust. QMs interpret but cannot correct the frame. [C]
Authority	Automated system	Fused with sensing — automated consequence without review separation	Publicly visible terms and contributor reports are consistent with score-mediated signals affecting access, pay, routing or deactivation without a sufficiently legible contributor-accessible review layer. This creates a structural exposure pathway; it does not establish legal causation or liability. [B][D][E]
Memory	Project-local (public evidence)	Local and non-portable — no cross-project contributor record identified	System cannot accumulate a durable contributor signal across projects. Routing improvement is constrained where continuity is not retained. [A][B][C]

CRITICAL FUSION — STRUCTURAL EXPOSURE PATHWAY [B][D][E]

The critical fusion: sensing and authority are collapsed in the visible scoring architecture. A mis-specified sensor operating at scale can turn classification error into consequence rather than leaving it as a correctable signal. Publicly visible terms and contributor reports are consistent with score-mediated signals affecting deactivation or pay without a sufficiently legible contributor-accessible review layer. This fusion is structurally consistent with some of the consequence evidence documented in Sections 11 and 14. It does not establish that the architecture caused any particular legal claim, regulatory action, or individual outcome.

Interpretation fragmentation: Queue Managers are the de facto interpretation layer but have no design authority and cannot correct upstream errors [C]. Glassdoor: “Directions change every minute and are inconsistent amongst reviewers.”

SECTION 8

STRUCTURAL FAILURE POINT

DIAGNOSTIC LAW

A contributor system fails at the handoff when the signal used to admit contributors differs materially from the signal used to evaluate them. The public evidence reviewed is consistent with Outlier exhibiting this failure pattern.

The first structural break: the qualification-to-execution handoff

This is the moment a contributor who entered through expertise-coded recruitment receives their first project-specific rubric. It is where the system's two grammars meet and where the mismatch becomes operational.

The contributor is selected using expertise signals — degree, domain knowledge, specialist identity [A][B]. At the handoff, project-specific instructions can specify formatting, length, time constraints, response structures and scoring rubrics [A][B][C]. The question can shift from *what is the correct answer given your expertise?* to *what answer conforms to this rubric?* Where domain judgment and rubric instructions diverge, the visible scoring architecture appears to privilege rubric conformity.

SHARPEST STRUCTURAL CLAIM — PUBLICLY SUPPORTED [C][E]

Where specialist judgment diverges from the rubric, the visible scoring architecture appears to treat that variance as error rather than value. In that condition, expertise becomes operationally unsafe: the contributor is rewarded for conformity to the rubric, not for correct domain variance. The system does not need to intend this outcome for the structure to produce it. The visible architecture appears to create structural incentives against exercising expertise when expert variance conflicts with rubric conformity. — Glassdoor [C]: "Marked as incorrect for giving the technically accurate answer because it didn't match the rubric wording."

What the break is not

- → **Not a guideline clarity problem** — clearer guidelines can intensify the signal-switch [E]
- → **Not a contributor skill problem** — the system is not primarily designed to consume open-ended specialist judgment [A][B][E]
- → **Not a routing inefficiency** — routing is downstream of the handoff [E]
- → **Not experts applying rubrics** — specialists applying a well-made rubric consistently is legitimate reliability work. The break is narrower: where the rubric scores correct domain variance as error, and no governed route to correct the rubric was identified [E]

The three capability modes

MODE	DESCRIPTION	HOW OUTLIER HANDLES IT
Execution reliability	Stable instruction adherence under monitoring	Actively selected for. This is the actual operating need. [A][B]
Diagnostic capability	Error detection within defined criteria	Partially present via Reviewer and Oracle tiers. [B][C]

MODE	DESCRIPTION	HOW OUTLIER HANDLES IT
Generative reframing	Detecting that the criteria or boundary are wrong	No public contributor-facing route with demonstrated upstream authority was identified for purchasing or routing this capability. [A][B][E]

What generative reframing would look like in practice [E]: A contributor identifies that a rubric or task boundary is wrong, submits a structured defect report, and the report reaches a review node with authority to change the rubric or task definition. The corrected definition then governs future work. No public contributor-facing generative-reframing route with demonstrated upstream authority was identified in the evidence reviewed, including at the Queue Manager tier.

Evidence of the break

Trustpilot [C]

> *"I took a test for my area of expertise, with no indication of which skills were required. The test asked me about technologies I did not have experience with. Then it removed me."*

Glassdoor [C]

> *"There are often very long tasks that require more time than the paid time. So you are basically working as free labour after that. You then get a warning for using a long time for those extremely long tasks."*

BBB complaint, November 2024 [C]

> *"Since joining Outlier, I have dedicated hundreds of unpaid hours to onboarding processes, training tutorials, assessment tasks, and project-specific modules."*

McKinney v. Scale AI [D] — allegation-level evidence

> *Workers not compensated for time reviewing instructions, attending mandatory webinars, or completing onboarding. Effective hourly rate alleged to be below California minimum wage when unpaid time is included.*

SECTION 9

COMPENSATION AND HIDDEN BURDEN

The platform appears to function. Tasks are completed. Scores are issued. The strongest structural reading is that it functions because a set of informal human carriers is performing the coherence functions the architecture does not formally support.

Primary carrier — Queue Managers

Queue Managers (Attempter → Reviewer → Oracle → Queue Manager) are contributors, not employees [B]. Their documented functions: hosting webinars, running war rooms, moderating Slack, answering questions the platform's documentation cannot answer [C].

Their recurring function is absorbing structural ambiguity. When guidelines change, scoring is opaque, or queue state is unclear, QMs provide interpretation [C]. This is load-bearing coherence work. The recurring QM interpretation burden indicates that some contributor-facing coherence is being carried by a human layer outside the formal interface rather than by the information architecture itself.

Critically: QMs cannot correct the frame. They can answer "how do I comply with this guideline?" They cannot answer "is this guideline correctly framed?" The structural problem generating the ambiguity they absorb remains invisible to the only human layer with system-adjacent access [C][E].

Secondary carrier — contributors themselves

Contributors carry significant unpaid coherence burden: repeated project-specific onboarding, queue-state inference assembled from community forums and GitHub tools rather than platform information, and guideline interpretation effort not compensated as task time [C][D].

THE EMPTYQUEUE-EXTENSION — THIRD STRUCTURAL CARRIER

The EmptyQueue-Extension (GitHub) was built to surface 19 EQ reason codes not surfaced in the contributor-facing interface. The codes are visible in the platform environment through browser network data. Their absence from the contributor UI is therefore not explained by lack of underlying state information. The structural effect is to externalise interpretation work to contributors, QMs and external tooling. Demand scarcity or project availability can still explain an empty queue; the diagnosed issue here is opacity about the state and reason. The resulting inference, interpretation and queue-management burden is a form of shadow coordination work that does not appear in task-time accounting.

Economic consequence (allegation-level evidence [D]): Per the Rogowicz PAGA suit, contributors are alleged to have worked 10-hour days while compensated for approximately 5. The system externalises its coordination costs onto contributors.

SECTION 10

GOVERNING DIAGNOSIS

Outlier's recurring friction is not best explained as a contributor capability problem, a guideline clarity problem, or a routing inefficiency. The structural reading — derived from convergent public evidence across the recruitment surface, operating mechanics, symptom pattern, and legal record [A][B][C][D][E] — is this:

THE GOVERNING DIAGNOSIS — COMPLETE STATEMENT

The platform recruits through the grammar of expertise while operating through the control grammar of a reliability pipeline. Because intake and operating architecture describe different inputs, the system can generate expectation mismatch at qualification, routing opacity at the queue, compensatory support burden at the QM layer, quality variance at the scoring layer, and dispute or reputational pressure at the consequence surface. Interface-level corrections do not replace the upstream primitive. The observable effect is that expert-coded recruitment can feed an operating layer that primarily consumes compliance-governed output. These are not the same production object; interface improvement alone cannot make them converge.

SECTION 10.1

PRIMITIVE MISMATCH TABLE

DIMENSION	STATED	ACTUAL
Primitive	Expert human judgment improves advanced AI systems	Variance-controlled instruction adherence at scale

DIMENSION	STATED	ACTUAL
What is purchased	Open-ended specialist reasoning	Repeatable rubric-conformant output
What is measured	Depth of domain judgment	Formatting, time adherence, rubric alignment
Who succeeds	Domain experts (stated)	Rubric-compliant performers (actual)
Who is penalised	—	Contributors whose specialist judgment produces rubric variance can be disadvantaged where conformity is the scored signal
Who churns	—	Public reports include credentialed and high-signal contributors who disengage; the evidence does not establish that the highest-credentialed cohort churns fastest

SECTION 10.2

WHY THE MISMATCH IS STRUCTURAL, NOT INCIDENTAL

The mismatch is structurally consistent with a collision between Scale AI's need for reliable, scalable, quality-controlled inputs [A] and an expertise-coded recruitment surface [A][B]. Reliability execution suppresses variance; genuine expert judgment sometimes requires correct variance to be preserved. The same gate and scoring layer cannot safely treat those as one work class without creating conflict [E]. This statement describes the structural condition, not a claim about motive for the recruitment language.

This is unlikely to resolve itself: the commercial mandate continues to produce the conditions for it. Until the primitive is named and the two work classes are formally separated, the mismatch remains liable to be regenerated by the same structural conditions that sustain it.

SECTION 10.3

VALIDATION TEST

If Outlier were to implement the Vanish List in Section 12 and internally declare its production primitive as "reliability pipeline with an optional expert judgment stream," would the remaining friction pattern be explained by execution quality rather than structural mismatch? If yes, the diagnosis holds.

Measurable signals that would confirm the diagnosis without full redesign:

- → Expose EQ reason codes (19 exist in browser developer tools; no new data collection required). If churn among high-signal contributors (high-signal defined by validated performance, accepted expert signals or demonstrated work-type fit — not credentials) declines materially after exposure, queue opacity was a primary driver — diagnosis supported. If QM interpretive load falls but specialist churn is unchanged, opacity was a symptom rather than the main driver of churn — diagnosis still holds but the mechanism requires refinement.
- → Pause intake and run a pilot with a reliability-only gate (no credential-density requirement). If churn among new hires drops materially and QA variance decreases, the gate was admitting the wrong input class.
- → Run a single project with an explicit rubric-challenge interface. If contributors surface structural rubric errors that improve task quality when corrected, generative reframing capability exists in the contributor pool but has no structural route.

Falsification condition: If specialist-contributor friction persists after the primitive is correctly named and the gate is rebuilt, revisit whether the fixed constraints in Section 2 prevent full correction or whether the mechanism has been misidentified. The diagnosis is supported where the symptom pattern maps to the primitive mismatch; the convergent evidence currently supports that reading [A][B][C][D][E].

STRONGEST FALSIFIER — SECTION 10.3

Strongest falsifier: if Outlier separates its recruitment promise, qualification gate, scoring logic, consequence review, queue-state visibility, and cross-project contributor memory — yet the same specialist-churn, QM-burden, queue-opacity, and quality-variance pattern persists under comparable demand — the diagnosis must be revised. The diagnosis holds if and only if correcting the primitive changes the symptom pattern. If it does not, the fixed constraints in Section 2 prevent correction and the redesign scope must be renegotiated.

SECTION 11

COST OF CONTINUATION

A directional assessment of costs generated by the unresolved primitive mismatch. These are structural inferences from public evidence, not internal financial data.

Retained-capability loss — repeated reacquisition

The platform recruits, screens, verifies and onboards contributors whose full capability the production layer is not primarily designed to consume [A][B][C]. Where a credentialed contributor is repeatedly requalified, routed into work that suppresses the capability used to recruit them, or exits before that capability is retained, intake value is reacquired rather than accumulated. Public evidence does not establish a population-wide churn rate for a defined high-signal cohort.

RETAINED CAPABILITY

The structural cost is not simply recruitment cost. It is failure to retain and reuse acquired specialist capability. Where project boundaries reset contributor signal, or specialist judgment is recruited but not operationally consumed, the system repeatedly pays intake and qualification costs without accumulating the full value of prior performance. This is a structural inference [E], not a claim that an individual contributor's economic value reaches zero or that depreciation occurs within a fixed number of days.

Support overhead — structurally recurring

The recurring QM infrastructure visible in the public evidence is consistent with a compensatory layer that has become structurally load-bearing rather than temporary scaffolding [C]. It cannot be reduced without correcting the underlying ambiguity that creates demand for it.

QA inflation — non-linear under scale

Additional compliance layers can increase QA cost without resolving variance generated by the primitive mismatch; execution-layer correction does not by itself establish primitive correction [E].

Upstream client risk — signal mismatch [E]

Because no public contributor-facing route with demonstrated upstream authority was identified for surfacing structural problems in rubrics or task definitions [A][B], malformed definitions may persist or

scale rather than being corrected upstream. If expert judgment is implied at recruitment but production rewards rubric conformity, the delivered signal can differ from the capability implied by the recruitment surface. This is a structural risk, not a claim about any specific client contract, model outcome, client knowledge, or internal quality standard.

Legal and regulatory exposure — structural pathway, magnitude unquantified

Public litigation and regulatory reporting form consequence evidence [D], not adjudicated proof of the governing diagnosis. A federal DOL investigation reported in March 2025 was reported closed in May 2025 without a public finding of wrongdoing. The sensing-authority fusion identified in Section 7 is better treated as a structural exposure pathway: score-mediated signals can affect consequence without a sufficiently legible review layer. The magnitude, timing and legal significance of that pathway cannot be quantified from public evidence.

Reputational damage — directional and observable

National press and investigative coverage are observable consequence evidence. Separately, Scale / Remotasks received 1/10 in Fairwork's 2023 Cloudwork Ratings, and Remotasks received 2/10 in the 2025 ratings. Neither is a current Outlier-specific rating, and neither should be read as one.

The compounding dynamic — recurrence while the primitive remains

STAGE	MECHANISM	STRUCTURAL ORIGIN
1	Retained-capability loss increases reacquisition pressure	Wrong gate admits wrong population
2	Cost pressure → more algorithmic quality management	No primitive correction; execution-layer response
3	More QA → more scoring opacity	Sensing-authority fusion deepens
4	More opacity → more contributor frustration	Queue-state opacity; review route insufficiently legible
5	More frustration → more complaints and disputes	Ghost-structure visibility rises; dispute exposure can increase
6	More compliance → more signal-switch intensity	Guidelines lengthen; expert-compliance gap widens
7	Credentialed contributors disengage or are requalified → retained capability is lost	Cohort effect must be measured rather than assumed
8	More retained-capability loss → return to Stage 1	Recurrence remains structurally likely while the primitive remains unchanged

Structural upside if corrected: A correctly scoped reliability pipeline — with accurate recruitment, a gate that selects for actual production need, transparent queue logic and separated consequence review — is designed to reduce recruitment reacquisition, QM burden, dispute exposure and contributor churn. Those effects require measurement under the proof conditions; they are not guaranteed by implementation alone.

SECTION 12

CORRECTION DEPENDENCY ORDER

This is a dependency order, not a list of recommendations. Right fixes in the wrong sequence still fail. This section identifies what must become true before valid correction can hold. The Full Redesign Artifact (Artifact 04, Section 10) expands this diagnostic order into the six-move implementation sequence.

Vanish List — non-negotiable refusal conditions

These are refusal conditions, not negotiable starting points for redesign conversations. Behaviours that reproduce the failure stop immediately. Structures that reproduce it stop before their replacement becomes the official path. Nothing scales while a refusal condition is still active. All four below are behaviours, so all four stop immediately. Redesign that scales while any of them persists will replicate the mismatch in its first phase.

STOP	WHY	FAILURE IF NOT STOPPED
Using credential density as a proxy for production quality	Credentials predict expertise. The system is not primarily designed to consume expertise. The gate selects the wrong population. [A][B][E]	Wrong population continues entering the wrong stream
Treating longer guideline documents as a response to quality variance	Where the primitive remains mismatched, additional specification can intensify the signal-switch by increasing compliance load without resolving the underlying work-class mismatch. [C] [E]	Expert-market promise continues collapsing into compliance burden
Treating the Empty Queue as a communication problem	19 EQ reason codes exist in the platform environment [B][C]. Demand scarcity may explain an empty queue; the diagnosed issue is that contributor-relevant queue-state information is not fully surfaced.	Ambiguity remains socially carried; support burden stays load-bearing
Continued volume growth before primitive correction	Additional intake before the primitive is corrected can deepen the mismatch by feeding the old frame.	Redesign begins while old intake compounds structural waste

These are the four diagnostic-level refusal conditions. The full implementation Vanish List (six items) is in Artifact 04, Section 8.

Correction sequence — five diagnostic conditions

These are the conditions that must become true, in dependency order. They are diagnostic conditions, not implementation moves: Artifact 04 turns them into its six-move transition sequence.

Condition 1 — Primitive correctly named (prerequisite for everything else)

Name the primitive correctly.

The system must decide, at leadership level, what it is actually purchasing: reliable repeatable instruction adherence at scale, genuine open-ended specialist judgment, or both separated into distinct streams. Subsequent design decisions depend on that declaration. Without it, downstream correction remains inside the old frame [E].

Owner	Platform leadership and Scale AI executive layer
Risk if skipped	All subsequent moves will be interpreted through the old frame and will partially replicate the mismatch
Redesign reference	Artifact 04, Section 10, Move 1

Condition 2 — Qualification logic aligned to production need (follows from Condition 1)

Redesign the qualification gate to select for the actual production need.

The current gate selects for expertise signals. The platform is not primarily structured to consume expertise. The gate must be rebuilt to select for what the system actually requires.

Owner	Product management and contributor operations
Risk if skipped	Any work-stream separation replicates the mismatch in two streams instead of one
Redesign reference	Artifact 04, Section 10, Move 2

Condition 3 — Work classes separated (follows from Condition 2)

Separate the two legitimate work classes currently collapsed into one broken frame.

The public evidence is consistent with two structurally different kinds of work: constrained reliability execution and genuine expert judgment [A][B][C][E]. Collapsing them into one frame with one gate and one scoring system produces the mismatch.

Owner	Product management
Risk if skipped	Separation becomes cosmetic; mismatch persists in two streams
Redesign reference	Artifact 04, Section 10, Move 2 / target dual-stream architecture

Condition 4 — Portable contributor continuity established (follows from Condition 3)

Establish portable cross-project contributor continuity.

Public contributor evidence is consistent with repeated project-level requalification and fragmented performance memory [A][B][C]. Correction requires a durable continuity record that can carry verified contributor signal across project boundaries.

Owner	Engineering
Risk if skipped	Routing cannot accumulate contributor history; the system repeatedly reacquires signal
Redesign reference	Artifact 04, Section 10, Move 3

Condition 5 — Governed expert-signal route established (follows from Condition 4)

Install a governed expert-signal route with upstream authority.

No public contributor-facing route was identified through which a contributor can surface a structural rubric or task-definition defect to a layer with authority to change it [A][B][E]. The correction is not merely a feedback box: the signal must be reviewable and capable of changing the upstream object.

Owner	Product and engineering
Risk if skipped	Expert variance remains detectable but structurally unable to change the frame
Redesign reference	Artifact 04, Section 10, Move 5

DEPENDENCY SUMMARY

Condition 5 depends on Condition 4. Condition 4 depends on the work-class separation established by Condition 3; Condition 3 depends on the qualification logic in Condition 2; Condition 2 depends on the primitive declaration in Condition 1. The documented correction responses examined here act downstream of the primitive rather than replacing it.

Artifact 04 expands this five-condition diagnostic order into six implementation moves: primitive declaration → stream-specific gates → continuity record → queue visibility and consequence review → expert signal channel → retirement of the legacy single frame.

Consequence review — separating automated scoring from irreversible consequence, the critical fusion named in Section 7 — is specified in Artifact 04 at Move 4b, after queue-state visibility at Move 4a.

Acceptance criteria: what must be true before implementation-level redesign

In a live engagement, redesign begins only after the governing diagnostic frame has been formally resolved and locked. The following conditions describe the decision boundary for this exemplar; they are not represented as a universal signature protocol.

1. Leadership resolves the primitive mismatch: reliability execution, expert judgment, or both as separated work classes.
2. The diagnostic refusal conditions are accepted as constraints on the redesign.
3. The five-condition diagnostic dependency order is accepted.
4. Intake and qualification decisions are not allowed to compound the old frame while replacement logic is being specified.
5. Where a Full Structural Engagement is commissioned, Artifact 04 provides the implementation-level replacement architecture.

SECTION 13

ROLE-LEVEL DIAGNOSTIC IMPLICATIONS

Structural translation of the diagnosis into diagnostic implications by role. These follow the dependency sequence in Section 12. For the full system object model, interface specifications and implementation sequence, see the Full Redesign Artifact (Artifact 04).

ROLE	DIAGNOSTIC IMPLICATION	MUST STOP ASSUMING	IMMEDIATE DIAGNOSTIC CHECK	REDESIGN REFERENCE
Engineering	Queue opacity and sensing-authority fusion are structurally material. The 19 EQ reason tags show the underlying state exists; surfacing contributor-relevant queue state is the highest-ratio immediate action. Automated scoring must be separated from deactivation and pay consequence.	That queue opacity is a UI problem.	Can contributors see their actual EQ reason code without external tooling?	Artifact 04 § 16 — Engineering Moves 3, 4a, 4b, 5
Product management	The qualification gate is measuring the wrong production input. Redesigning it is Condition 2 and cannot proceed until Condition 1 (primitive correctly named) is in place. Guidelines that change mid-project are a primary generator of QM support load.	That credentials predict production fit in the current frame.	Does the qualification gate test the work actually performed in production?	Artifact 04 § 16 — Product Move 2
Operations / QM layer	Queue Managers are carrying system coherence. Their interpretive function is load-bearing, not supplementary. Reducing QM burden requires correcting the system, not cutting QMs.	That more support infrastructure will resolve the ambiguity.	What percentage of daily QM work explains system ambiguity rather than genuine edge cases?	Artifact 04 § 16 — Operations
Founders and leadership	The primitive must be named before any redesign can hold. Resolve which work class each stream purchases before any redesign. Prevent intake growth from compounding the old frame while the new gate is specified.	That the failure is in execution quality.	Has the platform formally named which work class each stream purchases?	Artifact 04 § 16 — Leadership Move 1

SECTION 14

APPENDIX — EVIDENCE MAP

This map traces each major diagnostic claim to its evidence class and representative sources. It is designed to make the evidentiary basis of each structural claim impossible to dismiss as reliant on a single source class.

Evidence tier key

TIER	CLASS	DESCRIPTION
[A]	First-party claims	Outlier/Scale AI official surfaces — website, FAQ, blog, job pages, announcements, Community Guidelines, Terms of Service
[B]	First-party operating signals	Platform mechanics and governance documents — onboarding docs, pay structures, tier hierarchy, client codename structure

TIER	CLASS	DESCRIPTION
[C]	Convergent symptom evidence	Independent public platforms — Glassdoor, Indeed, Trustpilot, Quora, Reddit, BBB, GitHub (EmptyQueue-Extension). Treated as pattern evidence, not individual fact.
[D]	External consequence evidence	Legal filings (allegation-level), regulatory action, investigative and business press — McKinney, Rogowicz, psychological-harm litigation, Bloomberg, TechCrunch, Reuters, The Guardian, Fairwork (Oxford Internet Institute)
[E]	Structural inference	Frameworks from which the diagnostic logic is derived — The Expertise Illusion (Forrester 2026a), The Four-Function Law (Forrester 2026b)

Claim-to-source map

DIAGNOSTIC CLAIM	EVIDENCE TIER	REPRESENTATIVE SOURCES
Recruitment is expertise-coded	[A]	Outlier specialist job pages; Oxford Economics survey of 914 US Outlier annotators (84% held at least a bachelor's degree); LinkedIn cross-referencing in onboarding
Execution is reliability-coded	[A][B]	Onboarding documentation; 50+ page rubrics; algorithmic time-limit scoring; pay reduction for time overruns; task type definitions
Empty Queue opacity is recurring and structurally visible	[B][C]	19 EQ codes confirmed in developer tools (first-party platform); Reddit r/outlier_ai; Trustpilot; EmptyQueue-Extension (GitHub)
Queue Managers are load-bearing coherence carriers	[C]	Glassdoor, Indeed, Quora (tier progression confirmed); Reddit (QM function described); community-acknowledged webinars and war rooms
Sensing-authority fusion is structural	[B][E]	Terms of Service and Community Guidelines (consequence / deactivation architecture); Four-Function Law (Forrester 2026b). Public evidence does not establish the complete internal review architecture.
Consequence pressure is patterned, not random	[D]	McKinney v. Scale AI (Dec 2024); Rogowicz PAGA (Jan 2025); Bloomberg WARN Act reporting; TechCrunch DOL reporting (investigation reported Mar 2025; reported closed May 2025); The Guardian (Apr 2026); Fairwork ratings (Scale / Remotasks 2023; Remotasks 2025)
The governing diagnosis — expertise-coded reliability pipeline	[A][B][C][D][E]	Convergent across all five tiers. No single tier is sufficient alone. The structural inference is supported where all four lower tiers are consistent with it, as they are in the evidence reviewed.

SECTION 14.1

SOURCE REGISTER

Representative primary sources by evidence tier. This register names specific items rather than source categories. For live engagements, a full source log with archive dates is available on request.

TIER	SOURCE	SPECIFIC ITEM	USED FOR
[A]	Outlier official website	Specialist job pages, FAQ, blog posts, Marketplace announcements	Stated promise, recruitment grammar, official operating claims
[A]	Scale AI official materials	Historical AI-client relationships and company description; relationships changed after Meta's June 2025 investment. Current public reporting reviewed September 2026.	Parent system mandate and commercial constraint
[A]	Outlier official public company surface	Reports more than 100,000 Outlier experts working and earning globally	Scale of contributor population
[A]	Oxford Economics commissioned report	"The Economic Impact of the Data Annotation Industry", Oxford Economics, commissioned by Scale AI, December 2025. Survey of 914 US-based Outlier annotators: 84% held at least a bachelor's degree. Scale AI-commissioned; treated as first-party evidence of stated contributor composition.	First-party composition claims
[B]	Outlier Community Guidelines	Tier progression; deactivation policy; publicly documented consequence and review information	Operating signal: consequence structure, tier model
[B]	Outlier Terms of Service	Arbitration clause; deactivation terms; contractor classification	Operating signal: legal architecture, consequence authority
[C]	GitHub: andreytakhtamirov/emptyqueue-extension	EmptyQueue-Extension; 19 EQ reason codes surfaced from developer tools	Queue-state opacity as information-architecture condition
[C]	Glassdoor / Indeed / Trustpilot / Quora	Convergent contributor reports on signal-switch, rubric adherence, scoring opacity	Convergent symptom evidence; not treated as individual proof
[C]	Reddit r/outlier_ai	Queue Manager function, EQ code discussion, unpaid onboarding reports	Convergent community symptom evidence
[C]	BBB complaint database	Unpaid onboarding hours; November 2024 complaint cited in Section 8	Convergent symptom evidence
[D]	McKinney v. Scale AI	Filed December 2024; unpaid onboarding, below-minimum-wage allegations	Allegation-level consequence evidence; unresolved
[D]	Rogowicz PAGA	Filed January 2025; PAGA (California) labour violation allegations	Allegation-level consequence evidence; unresolved
[D]	Bloomberg / TechCrunch	WARN Act reporting (Oct 2024); DOL investigation reported March 2025 and reported closed May 2025	Public consequence evidence; closed DOL investigation produced no public finding of wrongdoing
[D]	Reuters (via CNBC) / TechCrunch	Meta's June 2025 investment in Scale AI; Google reported planning to cut ties (Reuters, 14 June 2025); OpenAI winding down its work with Scale (TechCrunch, 18 June 2025)	Change in parent-system customer relationships; context for demand-driven queue scarcity
[D]	The Guardian	April 2026; investigative coverage of Outlier platform conditions	Public consequence evidence: reputational pressure

TIER	SOURCE	SPECIFIC ITEM	USED FOR
[D]	Fairwork (Oxford Internet Institute)	Cloudwork Ratings 2023: Scale / Remotasks received 1/10. Cloudwork Ratings 2025: Remotasks received 2/10	Independent labour-standards evidence; neither is a current Outlier-specific score
[E]	The Expertise Illusion (Forrester 2026a)	Structural framework: expertise-coded recruitment into reliability-coded execution	Governing diagnosis [E]; not independently evidenced
[E]	Four-Function Law (Forrester 2026b)	Structural inference framework applied in Section 7	Structural diagnosis [E]; not independently evidenced

SECTION 15

APPENDIX — DIAGNOSTIC RESOLUTION RECORD

DIAGNOSTIC RESOLUTION RECORD — EXEMPLAR

This page shows how the governing diagnosis can be formally resolved before implementation-level redesign begins. It is not represented as the mandatory contract form for every current engagement, and no universal 14-day signature requirement is asserted here. Current practice is written-first and fixed-scope: the Diagnostic Artifact is delivered, the diagnostic frame is resolved and locked, and redesign begins only under a Full Structural Engagement. This public exemplar was not commissioned by Outlier or Scale AI.

In a live engagement, the purpose of resolution is to prevent redesign from being interpreted through an unaccepted or unstable diagnostic frame. The mechanism used to record that resolution may vary by engagement.

Resolution checklist

☐ **Primitive resolved**

Leadership records which work class it is purchasing: reliability execution, expert judgment, or both as separated streams. This resolution is the prerequisite for every subsequent move.

☐ **Diagnostic refusal conditions acknowledged**

The Section 12 refusal conditions are accepted as constraints on redesign. They are not treated as optional optimisation items.

☐ **Dependency order accepted**

The five-condition diagnostic dependency order in Section 12 is accepted. Artifact 04 expands it into the six-move implementation sequence.

☐ **Intake compounding addressed**

Leadership records how intake and qualification will avoid deepening the old frame while replacement architecture is being specified.

☐ **Full Redesign Artifact commissioned where applicable**

Artifact 04 is commissioned only under a Full Structural Engagement after the diagnostic frame is locked.

☐ **Expert signal condition acknowledged**

The public exemplar identifies no contributor-facing upstream-authority reframing route. A live engagement verifies the internal state before treating that condition as absent. Artifact 04 specifies the Expert Signal Channel at Move 5.

☐ **Build boundary accepted**

Stakeholders do not claim redesign success from partial implementation. Proof requires the replacement architecture to change behaviour under the original pressure.

☐ **Recapture risks noted**

Leadership notes that redesign must not create a new form of capture: an expert stream with no upstream task authority, or a continuity record that is not used for routing. Artifact 04 names these as recapture risks.

Resolution signatures (exemplar)

ROLE	NAME	SIGNATURE	DATE
Chief Executive Officer			
Chief Product Officer			
Chief Technology Officer			
Platform Operations Lead			

Where a live engagement uses a signed resolution record, the signed page records that the governing diagnostic frame has been resolved before implementation-level redesign begins.

CLOSING

CLOSING STATEMENT

> ***This artifact names the system condition that public evidence makes visible: a single contributor frame is being used to coordinate two incompatible work classes. Until that frame is corrected, the same failure will continue to reappear under new interfaces, stricter guidelines, and heavier support layers. The redesign is real only when the same pressure produces a different response.***

> **WHAT THIS DEMONSTRATES**
>
> This public diagnostic exemplar demonstrates the diagnostic logic, structural evidence tiering, governing diagnosis, and correction dependency order. It is not sufficient for implementation. The restricted Full Redesign Artifact (Artifact 04) contains the replacement architecture, transition sequence, refusal invariants, recapture gates, admissibility conditions, and builder handoff. This document demonstrates the method. The Full Redesign Artifact specifies the implementation.

This artifact was produced by Jamie Forrester, Independent Systems Architect, Edinburgh, UK. It is based entirely on publicly available information and was not commissioned by Outlier or Scale AI. The diagnostic logic, structural interpretation, and governing diagnosis are the author's own.

For the Full Redesign Artifact (Artifact 04) or the Translation Artifact (Artifact 01), contact:
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